

AI Essentials

Accessibility Conformance Report

WCAG Edition

VPAT® Version 2.5

Based on the ITI Voluntary Product Accessibility Template®. VPAT is a registered service mark of the Information Technology Industry Council (ITI).

Product Information

Field	Detail
Name of Product/Version	AI Essentials AI Literacy Certification Program — learner experience, July 2026 release
Report Date	July 2026
Product Description	Simulation-based AI literacy certification program delivered online to students and staff of partner institutions. The learner experience includes course lessons (text, images, and captioned video), scenario-based simulation activities, formative and summative assessments, downloadable portfolio materials, and a completion certificate. Courses are hosted on the Thinkific learning platform.
Contact Information	Michael Nowak, Founder AI Essentials — essentials-ai.com mnowak@essentials-ai.com 773-431-5587
Notes	This report covers the learner-facing experience as delivered to institutional partners. It does not cover Thinkific administrator or instructor tools, which are not used by partner learners. Thinkific publishes its own accessibility statement at thinkific.com/accessibility and maintains an ongoing third-party audit and remediation roadmap. Where a criterion depends on hosted platform behavior, this is noted in the remarks. Some simulation activities direct learners to third-party generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, Microsoft Copilot). Those tools are outside the scope of this report; each publisher maintains its own accessibility documentation. Every such activity includes an equivalent in-course alternative that can be completed entirely within the learning platform.
Evaluation Methods Used	Manual keyboard-only navigation of the complete learner flow (enrollment through certificate), including simulation activities and assessments. Screen reader testing with VoiceOver (macOS) and NVDA (Windows). Content review of video captions, narration, alternative text, heading structure, color contrast, and downloadable documents. Review of the hosting platform’s published accessibility statement (thinkific.com/accessibility).

Applicable Standards/Guidelines

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This report covers the degree of conformance for the following accessibility standard/guidelines:

Standard/Guideline	Included In Report
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.0	Level A: Yes Level AA: Yes Level AAA: No
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.1	Level A: Yes Level AA: Yes Level AAA: No
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.2	Level A: Yes Level AA: Yes Level AAA: No

Terms

The terms used in the Conformance Level information are defined as follows:

- **Supports:** The functionality of the product has at least one method that meets the criterion without known defects or meets with equivalent facilitation.
- **Partially Supports:** Some functionality of the product does not meet the criterion.
- **Does Not Support:** The majority of product functionality does not meet the criterion.
- **Not Applicable:** The criterion is not relevant to the product.
- **Not Evaluated:** The product has not been evaluated against the criterion. This can only be used in WCAG Level AAA criteria.

WCAG 2.x Report

Note: When reporting on conformance with the WCAG 2.x Success Criteria, they are scoped for full pages, complete processes, and accessibility-supported ways of using technology as documented in the WCAG 2.0 Conformance Requirements.

Table 1: Success Criteria, Level A

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A)	Supports	All images and diagrams in AI Essentials lessons and downloadable materials include text alternatives; decorative images are marked as such. Course player interface controls are labeled and were confirmed with screen reader testing.

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Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.2.1 Audio-only and Video-only (Prerecorded) (Level A)	Supports	Instructional media is video with synchronized audio; no audio-only or video-only content is used in the program.
1.2.2 Captions (Prerecorded) (Level A)	Supports	All prerecorded instructional videos include closed captions that are reviewed and corrected for accuracy before publication.
1.2.3 Audio Description or Media Alternative (Prerecorded) (Level A)	Supports	Video narration describes on-screen content (screens, diagrams, demonstrations) as an integrated description. Lesson text additionally provides a media alternative for the instructional content of each video.
1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)	Supports	Lesson content uses semantic headings, lists, and table markup. Downloadable PDFs are exported from structured Word/Google Docs source files with heading styles, preserving document structure. Course navigation and quiz structure are exposed programmatically.
1.3.2 Meaningful Sequence (Level A)	Supports	Reading order follows the visual order in lessons and assessments.
1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics (Level A)	Supports	Instructions do not rely solely on shape, color, size, or location.
1.4.1 Use of Color (Level A)	Supports	Color is not used as the only means of conveying information in course content. Quiz feedback includes text labels in addition to color.
1.4.2 Audio Control (Level A)	Supports	No audio plays automatically. Video playback is user-initiated with standard controls.
2.1.1 Keyboard (Level A)	Supports	The complete learner flow — navigation, lessons, video player, simulation activities, and assessments — was tested keyboard-only and is fully operable. Simulation activities that reference third-party generative AI tools have an equivalent in-course alternative that does not require leaving the platform.
2.1.2 No Keyboard Trap (Level A)	Supports	No keyboard traps were identified in keyboard-only testing of the learner experience.

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Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
2.1.4 Character Key Shortcuts (Level A)	Supports	No single-character keyboard shortcuts are implemented in course content.
2.2.1 Timing Adjustable (Level A)	Supports	Assessments are untimed by default. Where a timed assessment is configured, extended time is available upon request through the institution.
2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide (Level A)	Supports	No auto-updating, blinking, or moving content. Video is user-controlled.
2.3.1 Three Flashes or Below Threshold (Level A)	Supports	No flashing content.
2.4.1 Bypass Blocks (Level A)	Supports	Landmark regions and a consistent heading structure allow assistive technology users to bypass repeated navigation and move directly to lesson content.
2.4.2 Page Titled (Level A)	Supports	Each lesson and assessment page has a descriptive title reflecting course and lesson name.
2.4.3 Focus Order (Level A)	Supports	Focus order follows a logical sequence through navigation, content, and controls, confirmed in keyboard-only testing.
2.4.4 Link Purpose (In Context) (Level A)	Supports	Links in course content use descriptive text; generic "click here" links are avoided.
2.5.1 Pointer Gestures (Level A)	Supports	No multipoint or path-based gestures are required.
2.5.2 Pointer Cancellation (Level A)	Supports	Standard controls activate on up-event.
2.5.3 Label in Name (Level A)	Supports	Visible labels match accessible names for controls in course content.
2.5.4 Motion Actuation (Level A)	Supports	No motion-actuated functionality.
3.1.1 Language of Page (Level A)	Supports	Page language is declared (English) by the hosting platform.
3.2.1 On Focus (Level A)	Supports	No change of context on focus.
3.2.2 On Input (Level A)	Supports	No unexpected change of context on input; assessments require explicit submission.

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Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
3.2.6 Consistent Help (Level A, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	Support contact information appears in a consistent location across the learner experience.
3.3.1 Error Identification (Level A)	Supports	Assessment and form errors are identified in text.
3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (Level A)	Supports	Assessment items and input fields include visible labels and instructions.
3.3.7 Redundant Entry (Level A, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	Learners are not required to re-enter previously provided information within a session.
4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)	Supports	Controls in the learner experience expose name, role, and state to assistive technology, confirmed in screen reader testing with VoiceOver and NVDA.

Table 2: Success Criteria, Level AA

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.2.4 Captions (Live) (Level AA)	Not Applicable	No live media is delivered through the product.
1.2.5 Audio Description (Prerecorded) (Level AA)	Supports	Visual content in videos is described within the narration (integrated audio description); no visual information is conveyed without a spoken equivalent.
1.3.4 Orientation (Level AA)	Supports	Content is not restricted to a single display orientation.
1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose (Level AA)	Supports	Hosted platform component (Thinkific). Account and profile fields use standard autocomplete attributes.
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum) (Level AA)	Supports	Body text in lessons and downloadable materials is dark text on white or light backgrounds, exceeding the 4.5:1 minimum contrast ratio. Brand colors are used for headings and accents at conforming contrast.
1.4.4 Resize Text (Level AA)	Supports	Text can be resized to 200% without loss of content or functionality.
1.4.5 Images of Text (Level AA)	Supports	Text is presented as text rather than images, except for logos.

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Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.4.10 Reflow (Level AA)	Supports	Content reflows at 320 CSS pixels width without horizontal scrolling; the learner experience is responsive.
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast (Level AA)	Supports	Course content graphics and user interface components in the learner experience meet the 3:1 minimum contrast ratio.
1.4.12 Text Spacing (Level AA)	Supports	Content remains readable when text spacing is adjusted per the criterion.
1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus (Level AA)	Supports	No custom hover or focus content is used in course materials.
2.4.5 Multiple Ways (Level AA)	Supports	Lessons are reachable via the course outline navigation and sequential next/previous controls.
2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)	Supports	Headings and labels are descriptive.
2.4.7 Focus Visible (Level AA)	Supports	A visible focus indicator is present on all interactive elements, confirmed in keyboard-only testing.
2.4.11 Focus Not Obscured (Minimum) (Level AA, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	Focused elements remain visible and are not hidden by sticky headers or overlays, confirmed in keyboard-only testing.
2.5.7 Dragging Movements (Level AA, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	No drag-and-drop interactions are required to complete the program.
2.5.8 Target Size (Minimum) (Level AA, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	Interactive targets in course content and the course player meet the 24 by 24 CSS pixel minimum or have sufficient spacing.
3.1.2 Language of Parts (Level AA)	Supports	Course content is in English; no passages in other languages.
3.2.3 Consistent Navigation (Level AA)	Supports	Navigation is consistent across all lessons and courses.
3.2.4 Consistent Identification (Level AA)	Supports	Components with the same function are identified consistently.
3.3.3 Error Suggestion (Level AA)	Supports	Where errors are detected, correction suggestions are provided.

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Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
3.3.4 Error Prevention (Legal, Financial, Data) (Level AA)	Supports	Assessment submissions can be reviewed before final submission.
3.3.8 Accessible Authentication (Minimum) (Level AA, WCAG 2.2)	Supports	Hosted platform component (Thinkific). Login uses email and password with browser password-manager support; no cognitive function test is required.
4.1.3 Status Messages (Level AA)	Supports	Assessment results and progress confirmations are presented as page content and were announced correctly in screen reader testing.

Table 3: Success Criteria, Level AAA

Level AAA criteria were not evaluated for this report.

Accessibility Commitment and Remediation

AI Essentials is committed to providing an accessible learning experience for all students. Where this report identifies partial support, AI Essentials will:

- Provide an equivalent alternative format or activity for any affected learner within five business days of a request from the partner institution.
- Support the partner institution in preparing an Equally Effective Alternate Access Plan (EEAAP) where required by campus policy.
- Review and reissue this report at least annually, or sooner when the hosting platform publishes material accessibility updates.

Accessibility feedback and accommodation requests: mnowak@essentials-ai.com

Legal Disclaimer

This document is provided for information purposes only and reflects the results of testing performed on the dates and with the methods described above. It does not constitute a warranty. Hosted platform behavior is maintained by Thinkific and may change independently of AI Essentials content.